MODULE 24 · DOMAIN 6 - GOVERNANCE, RISK AND RESPONSIBLE USE

Ethics: Fairness, Transparency and Accountability

Bias and its proxies, telling people AI was involved, a named owner for every outcome, and the ethics review sequence.

DOMAIN 6 of 7 EXAM WEIGHT 15% MODULE 24 of 33

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Before using an output, ask three questions: is it fair, is it open, and who answers for it?

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Three ethical questions

QUESTION	WHAT IT ASKS	IN PRACTICE
Fairness	Are people treated consistently, without disadvantaging a group?	Same criteria for all; check for proxies
Transparency	Do the people affected know AI was involved, and how?	Disclose where expected or required
Accountability	Which named person owns the outcome?	A named owner; never "the AI decided"

ON THE EXAM

Fair, open, owned. An output that fails any of the three is not ready to use on people.

Where bias comes from

- **Bias:** "systematic patterns in outputs that unfairly favor or disadvantage certain groups or perspectives" (AI Fluency).
- **The model:** patterns learned from the text it was trained on.
- **Your prompt and examples:** leading wording, or examples drawn from one group.
- **Your data and criteria:** past decisions that encode past bias, and proxies for protected characteristics.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> Bias can enter at every layer you control, not only the one you do not.

Protected characteristics, and the proxies that hide them

PROTECTED CHARACTERISTIC	A PROXY THAT CAN STAND IN FOR IT
Age	Graduation year; "recent school leaver"
Race, including nationality	"Native English speaker"; postcode
Pregnancy and maternity; disability	Unexplained gaps in employment
Sex	Part-time history; certain job titles
Religion or belief	Availability on particular days

ON THE EXAM

Removing the characteristic is not enough. Check what stands in for it.

Fairness checks you can run

CHECK	HOW
Same criteria for everyone	Fixed, job-related criteria in the instructions
The swap test	Change only a name, age or gender; compare the outputs
Proxy scan	Ask Claude to flag criteria that could stand in for a protected characteristic
Varied examples	Examples drawn from different groups
A person reviews the edge cases	Borderline and unusual cases go to a named reviewer

THE TIEBREAKER

Claude can help find bias. A person still decides what is fair.

Transparency

- **Tell the people affected** when AI materially shaped something about them.
- **Required in places:** high-risk uses under the Usage Policy, AI chat interfaces, tenders that ask.
- **Explain plainly:** what Claude did, and what the person decided.
- **Never deny AI involvement** when someone asks directly.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Transparency diligence: be honest about AI's role with everyone who needs to know.

Accountability, and the highest risks

- **A named person owns every outcome** and can explain it. "Claude wrote it" is not a defence.
- **That person needs authority and information** to change the result.
- **Highest risk one:** no human accountable for a decision about people.
- **Highest risk two:** systematic disadvantage to a group, repeated at scale.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> The worst combination is scale with no owner.

The ethics review sequence

01

Audience and impact

Who is affected, and how much.

02

Risks

Fairness, privacy, harm, proxies.

03

Transparency

Who needs to know, and what.

04

Revise or escalate

Fix the design, or take it to the owner.

05

Document

The review and the decision.

ON THE EXAM

Audience and impact first; document the decision last.

Ethics traps

THE TRAP	WHY IT FAILS
Removing protected fields and stopping there	Proxies carry the bias through
"The AI decided"	No one is accountable
Hiding AI use to avoid concern	Breaks trust, and sometimes the rules
Asking Claude whether its output is fair	A useful check, but a person still decides
Reviewing one case and assuming all are fine	Bias shows up as a pattern, across many cases
Different criteria for different applicants	Inconsistent treatment, by design

ON THE EXAM

Every trap either hides a pattern, or hides a person.

> Claude drafted interview questions for Halden's site supervisor role. Two read: "How would your family feel about weekend shifts?" and "Are you a native English speaker?"
>
> The role needs weekend work, and safety briefings are given in English.

What is the best next step?

A Keep the questions, since Claude drafted them

B Replace them with job-related questions about weekend availability and delivering briefings in English, and have HR review the full set

C Ask Claude to reword them more politely

D Use those two questions only with some candidates

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best next step?

A Keep the questions, since Claude drafted them

Who drafted it does not make it fair.

B Replace them with job-related questions about weekend availability and delivering briefings in English, and have HR review the full set

Ask about the job requirement, not the proxy.

C Ask Claude to reword them more politely

Polite wording, same proxies.

D Use those two questions only with some candidates

Inconsistent treatment, by design.

THE SIGNAL

Questions that probe family and nationality: ask about the job requirement itself.

> Halden's AI review group is ranking four proposals by ethical risk before its monthly meeting.

Which proposal carries the highest ethical risk?

A Claude drafts the monthly supervisor newsletter for the communications manager to edit

B Claude summarises operations meeting notes for attendees to check

C Claude decides which field staff are offered overtime across all regions, with no named reviewer

D Claude formats next month's cleaning rota into a table

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which proposal carries the highest ethical risk?

A Claude drafts the monthly supervisor newsletter for the communications manager to edit

Low impact, and a person edits it.

B Claude summarises operations meeting notes for attendees to check

Low impact, and attendees check it.

C Claude decides which field staff are offered overtime across all regions, with no named reviewer

Decisions about people's pay, at scale, with no owner.

D Claude formats next month's cleaning rota into a table

Formatting, with no decision about anyone.

THE SIGNAL

Decisions about people, at scale, with nobody accountable: the highest risk.

> Halden's customer success advisers use Claude to suggest replies during live chats with clients. Each adviser approves every reply.
>
> A client types: "Am I talking to a real person?"

Which two actions meet transparency and accountability? Choose two.

A. Answer honestly that an adviser uses an AI assistant to draft replies, and approves each one

B. Say that no AI is used, to avoid worrying the client

C. Let suggested replies go out unapproved after hours

D. Remove advisers' names from replies, so no individual is singled out

E. Keep a named adviser responsible for every reply that is sent

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two actions meet transparency and accountability? Choose two.

A Answer honestly that an adviser uses an AI assistant to draft replies, and approves each one

Honest about AI's role, and about the human approval.

B Say that no AI is used, to avoid worrying the client

Denies AI use when asked directly.

C Let suggested replies go out unapproved after hours

Removes the human approval.

D Remove advisers' names from replies, so no individual is singled out

Removes the named owner.

E Keep a named adviser responsible for every reply that is sent

A named person owns each reply.

THE SIGNAL

Asked directly: be honest. Every reply: a named owner.

> Claude drafted shortlisting criteria for Halden's regional supervisor role. One reads: "Graduated within the last five years."
>
> The role needs supervisory experience and a recognised site-safety qualification.

What is the best response?

A Keep it, because age is not mentioned anywhere

B Ask Claude whether the criterion is biased, and accept its answer

C Remove every criterion and shortlist by hand

D Replace it with the real requirement, such as supervisory experience or a safety qualification, and scan the other criteria for proxies

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best response?

A Keep it, because age is not mentioned anywhere

A proxy carries age bias without naming age.

B Ask Claude whether the criterion is biased, and accept its answer

A useful check, but a person decides.

C Remove every criterion and shortlist by hand

Throws away fair, job-related criteria too.

D Replace it with the real requirement, such as supervisory experience or a safety qualification, and scan the other criteria for proxies

Use the real requirement; scan for other proxies.

THE SIGNAL

A criterion that stands in for age: replace it with the real requirement.

Halden's marketing team wants Claude to tailor recruitment adverts for field cleaners to different audiences in the South region.

(1) Document the review and the decision.

(2) Identify who will see or be affected by the adverts, and the impact.

(3) Decide what to disclose about AI use, and to whom.

(4) Assess the risks, such as some groups never seeing the adverts.

(5) Revise the plan, or escalate it to the AI review group.

What is the correct order?

A 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

B 4, 2, 3, 5, 1

C 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

D 2, 4, 5, 3, 1

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct order?

A 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

Audience, risks, transparency, revise, document.

B 4, 2, 3, 5, 1

Assesses risks before knowing who is affected.

C 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

Decides disclosure before knowing the risks.

D 2, 4, 5, 3, 1

Revises before deciding transparency.

THE SIGNAL

Audience and impact first, the record last.

> A Claude-drafted apology email offered a client a goodwill credit the policy does not allow. The account manager approved and sent it.
>
> When the client complains, the account manager says: "Claude wrote it, not me."

Who is accountable, and what follows?

A Claude, because it wrote the email

B The account manager who approved and sent it, and the instructions and review step should be fixed too

C Anthropic, because it provides the model

D Nobody, because it was a tool error

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Who is accountable, and what follows?

A Claude, because it wrote the email

A tool cannot be accountable.

B The account manager who approved and sent it, and the instructions and review step should be fixed too

The person who approved owns it; fix the cause too.

C Anthropic, because it provides the model

The output became Halden's when it was sent.

D Nobody, because it was a tool error

"Nobody" is the highest ethical risk.

THE SIGNAL

Approved and sent: the sender owns it. Then fix the instructions and the review.

In five lines

- **Three questions:** is it fair, is it open, and who answers for it?
- **Fairness:** same criteria for all; check proxies, not just protected fields; run the swap test.
- **Transparency:** tell people when AI shaped something about them; never deny it when asked.
- **Accountability:** a named owner with authority; "Claude wrote it" is not a defence.
- **Ethics review:** audience and impact, risks, transparency, revise or escalate, document.

COMING UP

Next: Domain 7 opens with diagnosing poor outputs.